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The Crochet Cap Blueprint™

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BONUS 2 OF 4

Pricing *Guide*

The four-factor formula that turns "I don't know what to charge" into a number you can say with confidence — plus a worked example for every pattern in this collection.

Bonus guide

2026 edition

BONUS 2

Never undercharge again

Materials + time + overhead + profit — the four numbers every price is built from.

The single most common mistake new sellers make is pricing a handmade item like a store-bought one. A crochet cap competes with mass-produced hats on the shelf, but it isn't the same product — it's a one-of-a-kind, handmade piece, and the price needs to reflect the hours in it, not just the yarn.

The four-factor formula

FACTOR	HOW TO CALCULATE IT
1. Materials	Add up the exact cost of yarn used (by weight, not whole skein), plus findings — beads, interfacing, tassel cord.
2. Time	Track your hours honestly on your first 2–3 caps of each pattern, then multiply by a fair hourly rate for skilled handwork — even \$12–15/hr changes the number a lot.
3. Overhead	A small slice for wear on hooks/tools, packaging, and any selling-platform fees (Etsy, marketplace, payment processor).
4. Profit margin	Add 20–35% on top of the first three so growth is actually possible, not just break-even.

Worked example — Classic Crochet Visor Cap (Pattern 1)

SAMPLE CALCULATION

\$34–42 suggested retail

Materials ~\$9 (150g cotton + interfacing) · Time ~3.5 hrs @ \$14/hr = \$49 · Overhead ~\$3 · at 100% of labor this totals ~\$61, but most sellers price at 55-70% of full labor value for a first-season item to stay competitive while building a customer base — landing in the \$34–42 range for a first collection, rising as demand and reputation grow.

Worked example — Flower Keychain (bonus mini-pattern)

SAMPLE CALCULATION

\$8–12 suggested retail

Materials under \$1 · Time ~35–45 min · Priced as an accessible "add to cart" item that introduces new customers to your full-price caps.

⚠ THE MOST EXPENSIVE MISTAKE

Pricing only to "cover the yarn" is the #1 reason handmade sellers burn out — every sale technically loses money once your time is counted. Price for your time from the very first sale, even if it means selling fewer pieces at first.

Raising prices over time

- Every 10–15 sales of a pattern, raise the price 5–10% — demand at your current price is proof you can charge more.
- Limited seasonal colorways (page 10's Sunflower Motif in a holiday palette, for example) can carry a 15–20% premium over your standard line.
- Custom sizing or color requests are a fair place to add a \$5–10 custom-order fee.

Price with confidence.

Next: Bonus 3 · Photography Class, so your listing photos justify the price you just calculated.

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Bonus 2 of 4 · Pricing Guide